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E3 Mixed Tenses – Graffiti Warning Poster – Reading, Grammar & Error Correction – Teacher notes and answers

Teacher notes

Entry 3, about 2 hours. Real Hackney shop shutter poster (photo taken October 2026). Project the photo for the lead-in; the worksheet has a typed copy.

Aims

- Recognise and contrast present simple, present perfect, past simple and *will* future in a real text.
- Correct common learner errors (all taken from the poster itself).
- Discuss graffiti, property and threats; write a short notice using all four tenses.

Content warning: the original ends with a strong swear word. The worksheet stars it out. Crop or cover the bottom of the photo if you prefer.

Stages

Stage	Time	What happens
1. Lead-in	10 min	Show the photo. Pairs: Where is this? Who wrote it? Who is it for? How does the writer feel? Have you seen graffiti in Hackney? Is it art or a crime?
2. Vocabulary	15 min	Task 1: match words to meanings. Drill pronunciation: *graffiti, vandalise, property, warning, threat, promise*.
3. Reading	15 min	Task 2: read the typed poster, answer the questions. Check in pairs, then whole class.
4. Grammar noticing	20 min	Task 3: find one or more examples of each tense. Board the table. Concept check: *I have warned you many times* – Do we know when? (No.) Is it important now? (Yes.) *You didn't take my notes seriously* – Finished? (Yes.) *You will pay* – Now or later? (Later.)
5. Error correction	15 min	Task 4: the writer made mistakes. Learners find and fix them. Good confidence boost – native speakers make errors too.
6. Controlled practice	15 min	Task 5: gap fill – a calmer notice from the same shop.
7. Speaking	15 min	Task 6: role play – shop owner tells a police officer what happened. Swap roles.
8. Writing	15 min	Task 7: write a polite notice (40–60 words) using all four tenses. Stronger learners: write the graffiti artist's reply.

Discussion point (optional, stronger groups): the writer says “threat is a crime” – then threatens someone. Is this poster legal? What should the shop owner do instead? (Report to the police; use the CCTV as evidence.)

Answer key

Task 1: 1d, 2g, 3a, 4h, 5f, 6i, 7c, 8b, 9j, 10e

Task 2: 1 T · 2 F · 3 T (00:49) · 4 F (signed “The Punisher”) · 5 F (he says a threat is a crime) · 6 F (his parents didn’t teach him) · 7 notes · 8 the government and the artist’s parents · 9 Thursday

Task 3

Tense	Examples	Use
Present simple	This **is** my last warning. I **don’t make** threats. I **make** promises. Vandalising property **is** a crime.	Facts, things always true, habits
Present perfect	I **have warned** you many times. I **have locked** on to you.	Past action, result now; time not given
Past simple	You **didn’t take** my notes seriously. Your parents **didn’t teach** you… Don’t say I **didn’t warn** you.	Finished actions in the past
Future (*will*)	I **will have to** teach you a lesson. You **will pay** for your actions.	Promises, decisions, predictions

Task 4

1. many **times** (plural after *many*)
2. **someone’s** property (possessive *’s*)
3. **A threat** is a crime / **Threats** are crimes (article or plural)
4. I didn’t **warn** you (base form after *didn’t*)
5. **Is it** worth it? (question word order; no *what*)
6. *last* and *final* mean the same – use one

Task 5: 1 is · 2 opened · 3 has painted (this year isn’t finished) · 4 paid · 5 don’t want · 6 will report · 7 records · 8 will see

FOR TEACHER USE ONLY · Found a mistake? Teachers: scan to report it